
North Coast Regional Water Quality Control Board

June 18, 2018

Jerry Marcotte
CDOT Division of Engineering Services
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Jerry.Marcotte@dot.ca.gov

Dear Mr. Marcotte:

Subject: Notice of Applicability under General Waste Discharge Requirements for Small Domestic Wastewater Treatment Systems, Water Quality Order WQ 2014-0153-DWQ

File: CDOT Collier Tunnel Rest Area, Del Norte County; WDID No. 1A171868RDN

This letter serves as Notice of Applicability (NOA) from the North Coast Regional Water Quality Control Board (Regional Water Board) that the General Waste Discharge Requirements for Small Domestic Wastewater Treatment Systems, Order WQ 2014-0153-DWQ (General Order) is applicable to the subject wastewater system and that the system is henceforth regulated under the General Order as described below. A Monitoring and Reporting Program (MRP) for the wastewater system is included as an enclosure of this NOA.

Caltrans (Discharger) submitted a report of waste discharge (ROWD) dated September 22, 2017, for the Caltrans Collier Tunnel Roadside Rest Area located off Highway 199, northeast of Gasquet, in Del Norte County. Supplemental information regarding system design was provided on October 3, 2017, and April 17, 2018. Based on the information presented in the ROWD, the proposed wastewater treatment system and discharge are consistent with the requirements of the General Order.

The General Order contains requirements that apply to all wastewater systems and also requirements that apply only to specific types of treatment and/or disposal systems. Applicable site-specific requirements are discussed in Section 3 of the NOA. The Discharger is responsible for all applicable requirements in the General Order, this NOA, and the MRP.

The General Order is available on the Internet at:

https://www.waterboards.ca.gov/board_decisions/adopted_orders/water_quality/2014/wqo2014_0153_dwq.pdf

1. Facility and Discharge Description

Facility

The Caltrans Collier Rest Area (Facility) is owned and operated by Caltrans and is located directly off Highway 199, northeast of Gasquet in Del Norte County. The Facility is not located in an area served by a regional wastewater collection system; therefore, domestic wastewater is collected and treated on-site. The site location is shown on Attachment A, which is attached hereto and is made part of this NOA by reference.

The Facility serves as the only state-operated safety roadside rest area along Highway 199 between Crescent City California and Grants Pass Oregon. It consists of one comfort station building which has 5 toilets, 2 urinals and 6 sinks. Drinking water for the Facility comes from Johnny Walker Creek, Griffin Creek and one groundwater supply well. The Facility was not previously regulated under permit by the Regional Water Board.

The Facility's wastewater originating from the comfort station restroom will be treated and disposed of via the wastewater treatment system. The wastewater system will consist of collection system piping, grinder lift station, urine diversion tank, septic tank, upflow solids contact tanks, anaerobic media tanks, equalization tank and a subsurface pressure dosed drip disposal field.

Discharge Description

The domestic wastewater treatment system is designed for treatment of a mean daily flow of 1,900 gallons per day (gpd). As described in the ROWD, the projected untreated and treated domestic wastewater quality from the Facility is consistent with the characterization of wastewater in the General Order.

The plan layout of the wastewater collection system is included in the Engineers Report for California Department of Transportation, Division of Engineering Services, Collier Tunnel SRRA, prepared by Northstar, and dated September 25, 2017. These plans and reports are made part of this NOA by reference.

Primary Treatment and Collection System

Primary domestic waste treatment and collection will be provided using a gravity collection system, urine diversion tank and septic tank, as described below.

Wastewater from the comfort station flows to the lift station. The urinal wastewater drains to urinal storage tank where it is stored before draining back to the treatment process. The urine diversion tank will be connected to the solids process tank and pumped through the treatment process when flows and environmental conditions are favorable for increased nitrogen reduction. Grinder pumps in the lift station discharge the wastewater into a

6,000-gallon septic tank with an effluent filter. The septic tank is designed to provide for solids removal prior to effluent entering the secondary wastewater system.

Secondary Wastewater Treatment System

A secondary wastewater treatment system will be installed to reduce the organic strength and solids content of the domestic wastewater to levels that are protective of groundwater quality prior to disposal to the subsurface pressure dosed disposal field. The treatment system consists of upflow solids contact tanks, anaerobic media tanks, equalization tank, and piping, pumps, and controls. The treatment system can be operated locally at the facility as well as remotely using a cloud based Supervisory Control and Data Acquisition (SCADA) system. In case of power failures, a stand-by generator will be installed to provide electricity during electrical power outages.

Wastewater Discharge System

Following secondary level treatment, effluent will be disposed of at a subsurface pressure-dosed disposal field. A flow meter will measure the volume of effluent being discharged to the disposal field.

The subsurface disposal field will be located on the southwest side of the Facility. The disposal field is designed to dispose of 1,900 gpd mean daily flow and 5,700 gpd peak flow of effluent, with an application rate between 0.5 to 0.67 gallons/square foot/day. The disposal field will consist of 5,200 square feet of leachline parceled into three zones. A 100 percent reserve disposal field area has been designated. The disposal field, reserve area, and treatment system components meet the setback requirements in the General Order.

General WDR Order Coverage

Commencing on the date of this NOA, waste discharges from the Facility's domestic wastewater treatment system are regulated under the General Order (Order WQ 2014-0153-DWQ).

2. California Environmental Quality Act

On September 27, 2017, Caltrans certified a Categorical Exemption Class 1(b) under the California Environmental Quality Act (CEQA) for the construction of the wastewater system.

3. Site-Specific Requirements

A. General

The General Order contains prohibitions and specifications that apply to all wastewater systems covered under the General Order, and specifications that apply only to specific types of treatment and/or disposal systems. Discharges of wastes other than those described in the ROWD are prohibited.

Wastewater system managers and operators must be familiar with the applicable requirements contained in the General Order, this NOA, and MRP R1-2018-0040.

B. Reports to be Submitted to the Regional Water Board

1. The following technical reports, which form the main components of a comprehensive Operation, Maintenance, and Monitoring program, shall be submitted as described below:
 - a) By December 31, 2018, the Discharger shall submit a Spill Prevention and Emergency Response Plan (Response Plan) consistent with the requirements of General Order Provision E.1.a. The Response Plan shall, at a minimum, address the following:
 - 1) Operation and Control of Wastewater Treatment
 - 2) Solids and Sludge Handling
 - 3) Collection System Maintenance
 - 4) Emergency Response
 - 5) Notification Procedures
 - b) By December 31, 2018, the Discharger shall submit a Sampling and Analysis Plan consistent with the requirements of General Order Provision E.1.b.
2. The above reports shall be acceptable to the Regional Water Board's Executive Officer.

C. Septic Tank

The domestic wastewater system serving the Facility includes a 6,000-gallon septic tank that provides primary treatment of the wastewater. Septic tanks require proper operation, maintenance, and monitoring in order to provide adequate and reliable wastewater treatment. This includes periodic inspection and removal, as needed, of accumulated solids. Requirements for septic tanks are included in General Order Section B.2, Septic Systems, and in the enclosed MRP, at section titled "Septic Tank Monitoring and Maintenance." Operational maintenance and monitoring work on the septic system shall be conducted by qualified service providers approved by the Regional Water Board Executive Officer with appropriate oversight by the Discharger. The Discharger is responsible for ensuring proper operation, maintenance, and monitoring of all septic tanks.

D. Subsurface Disposal System Requirements

The domestic wastewater system includes dispersal of treated effluent to subsurface soil via a 5,200-square foot subsurface drip disposal system. The Discharger is required to include a constructed primary disposal system with capacity for 100 percent of design flows, and a 100 percent capacity designated reserve area. The reserve area is for future use, in case the existing disposal system is found to be inadequate. The reserve area is required to remain available until needed. The Discharger has designated a 100 percent capacity reserve disposal area.

By December 31, 2018, the Discharger shall submit "As-Built" Plans for the constructed subsurface disposal system and any associated groundwater monitoring wells.

4. Monitoring and Reporting Program

The Discharger shall comply with enclosed MRP R1-2018-0040, for the Caltrans Collier Tunnel Rest Area Wastewater Treatment System, which is made part of this NOA by reference.

The MRP includes requirements for the monitoring and maintenance of the urine tank, septic tank, and monitoring of the disposal field.

Quarterly self-monitoring reports and an annual summary report are to be submitted to the Regional Water Board in accordance with the MRP. The MRP should be consulted for all specific requirements.

5. Enforcement

The Discharger shall manage and discharge the waste subject to the terms and conditions of the General Order and this NOA and shall maintain exclusive control over the discharges. As such, the Discharger is responsible for compliance with the General Order and this NOA.

Failure to comply with the requirements in the General Order, this NOA, or the MRP could result in an enforcement action as authorized by provisions of the California Water Code.

California Water Code section 13267 states, in part:

"In conducting an investigation specified in subdivision (a), the regional board may require that any person who has discharged, discharges, or is suspected of having discharged or discharging, or who proposes to discharge waste within its region, or any citizen or domiciliary, or political agency or entity of this state who has discharged, discharges, or is suspected of having discharged or discharging, or who proposes to discharge, waste outside of its region that could affect the quality of waters within its region shall furnish, under penalty of perjury, technical or monitoring program reports which the regional board requires. The burden, including costs, of these reports shall bear a reasonable relationship to the need for the report and the benefits to be obtained from the reports. In requiring those reports, the regional board shall provide the person with a written explanation with regard to the need for the reports, and shall identify the evidence that supports requiring that person to provide the reports."

California Water Code section 13268 states, in part:

"(a) Any person failing or refusing to furnish technical or monitoring program reports as required by subdivision (b) of section 13267, or failing or refusing to furnish a statement of compliance as required by subdivision (b) of section 13399.2, or falsifying any information provided therein, is guilty of a misdemeanor and may be liable civilly in accordance with subdivision (b).

(b)(1) Civil liability may be administratively imposed by a regional board in accordance with article 2.5 (commencing with section 13323) of chapter 5 for a violation of subdivision (a) in an amount which shall not exceed one thousand dollars (\$1,000) for each day in which the violation occurs.”

The reports required in item 3.B of this NOA are necessary to ensure that the Discharger complies with the NOA and General Order. Pursuant to California Water Code section 13267, the Discharger shall submit the reports described herein.

Please review this NOA carefully to ensure that it completely and accurately reflects the discharge. If the discharge violates the terms or conditions listed, the Regional Water Board may take enforcement action, including assessment of administrative civil liability. Prior to allowing changes to the wastewater strength or generation rate, or if the method of waste discharge changes from that described in the ROWD, you must contact the Regional Water Board to determine if submittal of a ROWD is required.

6. Annual Fees

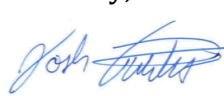
The waste discharge authorized by this NOA is subject to payment of annual fees under the State Water Board’s annual fee schedule for regulated discharges. Annual fees are based in part on ratings for threat to water quality and complexity. The subject Facility is rated 3-B. The annual fee for this rating in accordance with the current (FY 2017-2018) Fee Schedule is \$4,699; however, based on the flow rate, the discharge qualifies for the 50-percent fee discount. The annual fee for the discharge is currently \$2349.50.

The Fee Schedule is subject to change, and the fee for this Facility may change accordingly. Annual fees are due and payable as invoiced annually to the Discharger by the State Water Board.

7. Regional Water Board Contact Information

Regulation of the subject domestic wastewater treatment system under the General Order is managed by the Regional Water Board’s Land Disposal and Groundwater Permitting Unit. The case is currently assigned to Roy O’Connor. Questions or concerns about this NOA, the attached MRP, or related matters should be directed to Roy O’Connor at (707) 576-2670 or Roy.O'Connor@waterboards.ca.gov.

Sincerely,



FOR:

Matthias St. John
Executive Officer



Digitally signed by Joshua

Curtis

Date: 2018.06.18 15:24:51

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Attachments: Attachment A, Site Location Map
Attachment B, Wastewater Treatment System Schematic

Enclosures: Monitoring and Reporting Program R1-2018-0040

cc: Timothy O'Brien, State Water Resources Control Board, Sacramento,
Timothy.OBrien@waterboards.ca.gov

Brian McNally, Del Norte County Health Department, Crescent City,
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David Melendrez, Caltrans, Eureka
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Attachment A – Site Location Map



Attachment B – Wastewater Treatment System Schematic